

sections on family finance and how to build a nest egg published in the daily press and the human-interest magazines.

You can't turn the dial on the radio without passing through a roundtable discussion of tax-free municipal bonds. You can't open the mailbox without being invited to convert to Eurodollars, to switch from shorter to longer bond maturities, or to cash out of local certificates of deposit and invest in Australian government debt. You can't answer the telephone without hearing from the occasional penny-stock broker, regular stockbroker, or money manager who wants to introduce himself and chat about your economic objectives.

If you watch television, you're a cinch to get caught up in the financial news that abounds. They had to cancel "Dollars and Sense," hosted by a former football player—but "Money Line," "Money Talk," "Your Money," the "Nightly Business Report," and "Your Money Matters" more than make up for the loss. Louis Rukeyser of "Wall Street Week" has become the average person's Virgil on the subject. The Financial News Network runs an all-day business report above the stock quotes that pass across the screen, and this video ticker tape mesmerizes thousands if not millions of spectators as the voices of TV guests convince them to buy or sell shares.

The financial opportunities have multiplied and become so complicated that even the simplest wage earner is forced to strategize. Every routine household economic decision requires as much conniving as old John D. Rockefeller employed to control world oil production and the U.S. railroads.

You can't buy a car without wondering if you should accept the lower sticker price or take the reduced rate of interest, opt for deferred interest, lease the car with a buy-back provision, or go for the cash rebate, which then must be reinvested. The same applies to buying appliances and furniture. You can't walk through a shopping center without worrying whether you've got a competitive mortgage, since current yields are posted on every other storefront. You can't loiter in an airport without considering whether to leave your retirement account with the bank or transfer it to a brokerage firm. You can't frolic with your children without won-